

VMWare posts 12% profit

The popular virtualization service's first quarter reports show increased spending in virtualization and cloud based applications

Turbocharged USB 3.0

A-DATA flaunts 200MBps USB 3.0 powered solid state drives

Workshop

Windows virtually!

Stubborn apps have no excuse not to work on Windows 7

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Windows 7, as an operating system has been a huge success and Vista critics don't have as much to complain about. The only problem that people have is with the few applications that refuse to run on it. Designed for Windows XP and 2000, the software may not run in Windows XP compatibility mode. We've had quite a few people calling up with this problem. Thankfully, there is a way. Windows 7 Virtual PC allows you to run Windows XP as well as other operating systems. You don't need to even own Windows XP separately.

The component needs to be downloaded from Microsoft's site (www.microsoft.com/windows/virtual-pc/). Click on the "Get Windows XP Mode and Microsoft Windows Virtual PC now" link. Choose your version of Windows 7 and then the language. Download the links in the order and install

them. Microsoft's latest patch allows processors without hardware virtualization built in to run it as well. Just keep in mind that you'll need plenty of memory (1GB in addition to your existing memory preferably) for this to run well.

XP within 7

Once installed, click on the Start menu button and browse to All Programs > Windows Virtual PC. Click on the Windows XP Mode. Set the password for the XP mode and continue. Next, choose whether to use the network security features or not. Once that's done, the Virtual PC setup

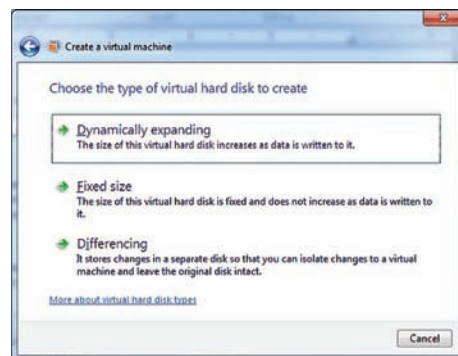


Windows XP running within the virtual machine

will begin. It'll take some time to complete – usually between 5 to 10 minutes.

Once that's done, the virtual machine will be ready for use. You can install programs on it just like you would on a dedicated PC running XP. All of the Windows XP and 2000 applications should run here without any problems. If you maximise the window, the virtual machine will switch to full screen mode. The local physical drives will still appear as drives but

as network drives. Flash drives and DVD drives can also be accessed without any hassles. You can use disc images



Selecting the type of virtual drive for the virtual machine

in the form of ISO and IMG files to install applications and software from. You can create additional virtual drives as well by clicking on Tools > Settings. Browse down to the Hard Disk 2 and 3 options.

Running another OS

The Windows 7 Virtual PC feature will also allow you to run other operating systems on it similar to what Virtualbox or VMWare do. To create other virtual machines, go to the same Windows Virtual PC menu in the Start menu, and click on Virtual Machines. This window shows you the list of all the already configured virtual machines. Click on Create virtual machine on the menu on top.

In this window, enter a name for the virtual machine and then the location for the VM data to be stored. Click Next, and enter the amount of

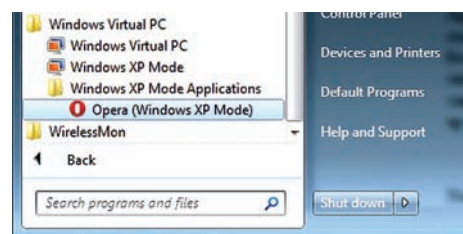
memory you would like to dedicate to this virtual machine. A minimum of 512MB should be allotted.

The next step is to create the drive for the virtual machine. You can either create a new virtual disk on your physical drive or use an existing drive that you might already have been using. With the advanced disk creation method, you can choose whether to have a fixed drive size or one that dynamically changes with the requirements.

The newly created virtual machine should show up in the window. Double-click on it to start the virtual machine. It should run in a window.

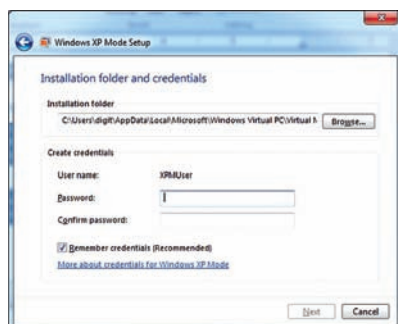
VM on host

Applications installed on the virtual machine can also be run by the host OS. For example, if you installed Opera on the XP virtual machine, you can also find the shortcut for it in the Windows Virtual PC menu. The application runs in the virtual machine but without the Virtual PC interface around



Opera installed within the virtual machine but accessible on Windows XP

the windows. This way, you can have all your programs setup in XP mode but access them without manually starting up the virtual machine every single time. 



Set the Windows account password for the virtual machine